

MORNING PRAYER OF ST JEROME

Lord Jesus Christ, as I rise in the morning, be attentive unto me and govern mine actions and my words and my thoughts, that I may pass the whole day within Thy will. Grant me Thy fear, O Lord, compunction of heart, lowliness of mind, a pure conscience, that I may scorn the world, ponder heaven, hate sins, and love righteousness. Take from my heart the cares of the world. Wrench from me, O Lord, the appetite for gluttony, the desire for fornication, the love of money, the plague of irritability, the sadness of this world, listlessness, empty joy, worldly pride. Plant in me, O Lord, the virtues: an abstaining body's self-containment, chastity, humility, and unfeigned brotherly love. Guard my mouth, Lord, that I may not speak vanities, nor tell worldly tales nor detract others in their absence, that I may not curse my parents, that I may not answer cursing with cursing, but rather with blessing. O Lord, let Thy praise be continually in my mouth. Guard mine eyes, Christ, that they may not see what is evil to lust after it, nor the delicacies of this world nor the goods of my neighbor, but let me say in the spirit of David, "Mine eyes are ever toward the Lord, for He it is that will draw my feet out of the snare", and again, "Unto Thee have I lifted up mine eyes, unto Thee that dwellest in heaven". Guard mine ears lest they listen to slander and lies or idle talk, but let them be opened every day to listen to the word of God, who heareth and reigneth unto ages of ages. Amen.

Psalm references: Ps 24:16, Ps 122:1

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